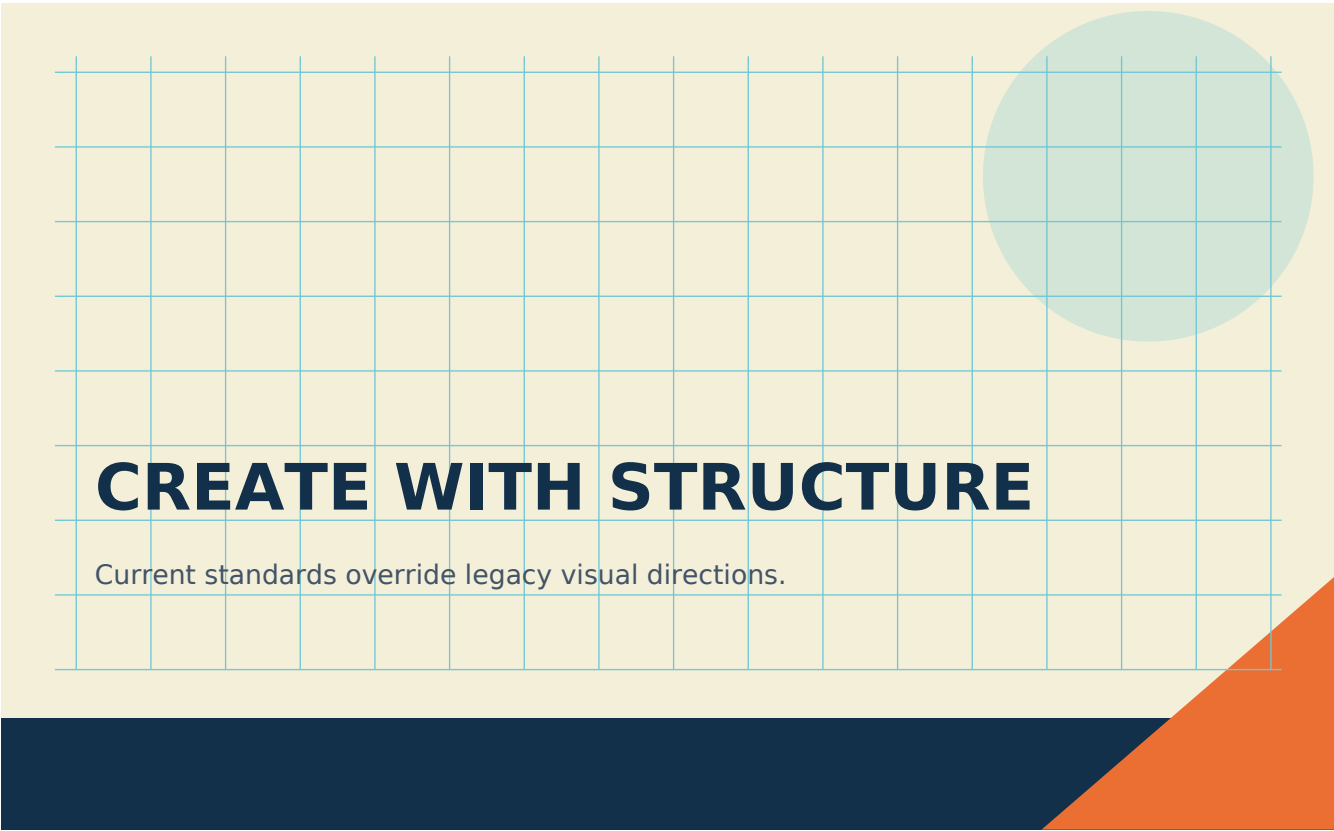


Northstar Admissions Visual Standards 2026

Paid social, event communication, and current admissions identity



Use this guide for brand treatment and visual composition. Asset eligibility and exact placement dimensions are controlled by the current workbooks supplied with each job.

1. Brand character

Northstar communications should feel creative, rigorous, welcoming, and grounded in real studio work. The visual system combines editorial structure with visible process: critique walls, sketches, models, tools, prototypes, and visitors engaging with the school.

Lead with the event

The event or program is the strongest message. Avoid generic institutional slogans.

Show process

Prefer critique, making, and conversation over staged graduation or generic office scenes.

Use current records

Never infer approval from a filename, year, or apparent visual similarity.

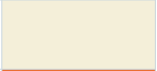
Design for the placement

Use the exact active placement profile and keep required content inside its current safe areas.

Editorial hierarchy	Visible process	Mobile readability
One strong title, a compact detail block, and a clear action.	Use real studio activity and retain campaign-specific cues.	Test the complete composition at phone size; do not rely on zoom.

2. Color and type

Navy and studio cream are the primary fields. Process orange is reserved for action and focus. Blueprint cyan supports grids, rules, labels, and spatial cues. Ink is used for text and fine detail.

Northstar Navy	#12304A	Primary structure and type	
Studio Cream	#F4EFD9	Primary light field	
Process Orange	#EB6E32	CTA and focal accents	
Blueprint Cyan	#70C7D5	Grid, rail, spatial cues	
Ink	#253746	Long-form text	

Color balance

The combined cream and navy fields should carry most of the image. Orange and cyan are accents, not competing full-canvas treatments. Do not recolor approved library assets to force a palette match.

Typography

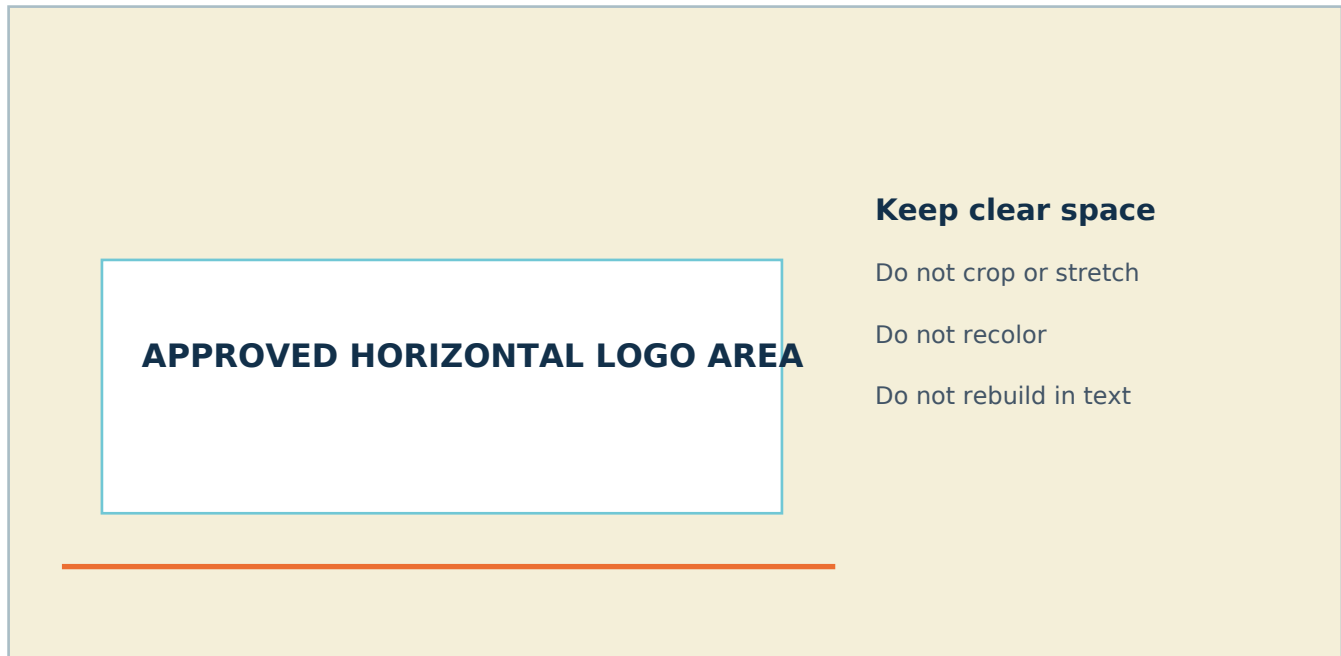
Use a clean editorial or geometric sans for the title and a functional sans for event details. Avoid scripts, distressed display type, condensed sale typography, or more than three type styles in one Story.

Readability floor

All required copy must remain readable on a 6-inch phone without zoom. Do not solve crowding by shrinking event details or the CTA below practical mobile size.

3. Logo treatment

Use only the eligible horizontal Northstar wordmark selected from the asset register. Preserve the complete starburst, NORTHSTAR wordmark, and DESIGN SCHOOL descriptor.

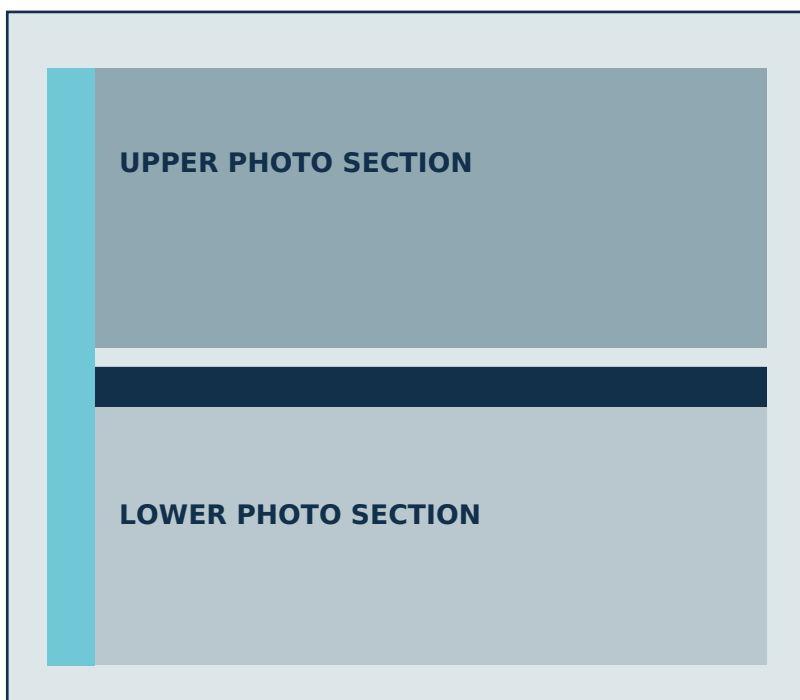


For a 1080-pixel-wide Story, a practical horizontal wordmark width is roughly 280-360 pixels unless the active placement profile is more restrictive. Maintain clear space equal to at least the height of the starburst around the full mark.

A small amount of edge proximity, descriptor loss, or stretching is not a minor brand variation; it is a failed logo treatment.

4. Hero image and crop

The approved campaign hero should remain the dominant visual. Preserve the visual evidence that identifies the selected campaign version.



Retain:

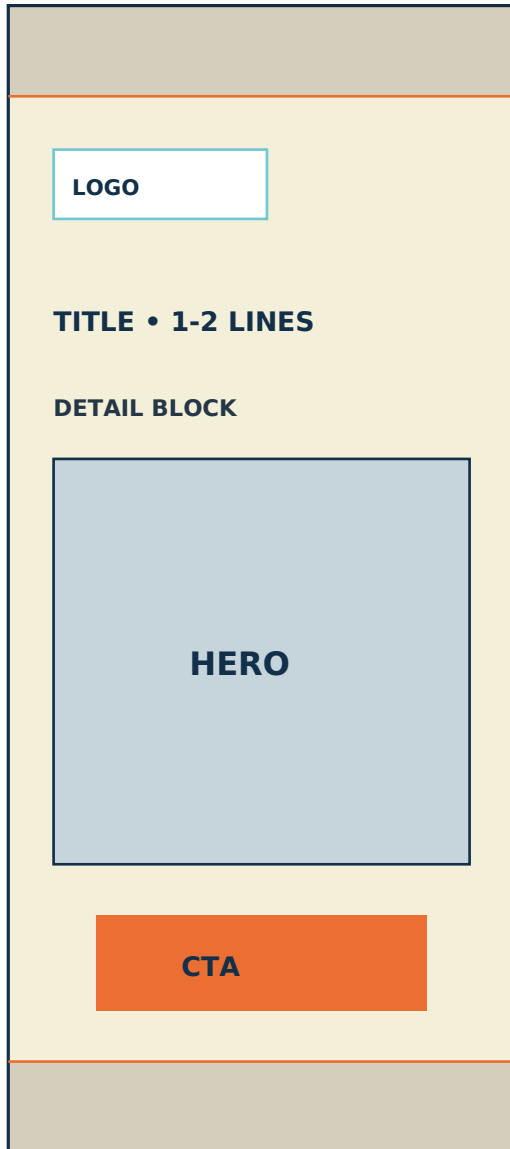
- both photo sections
- campaign labels
- divider / rail
- footer cue

Do not crop away the second photo section, the identifying footer cue, or all embedded campaign labels. Keep total crop within roughly 8% of the supplied hero unless the placement profile gives a tighter limit.

Do not cover the hero with large copy blocks, heavy blur, or decorative shapes that make its campaign-specific content impossible to identify.

5. Paid Story composition

The active placement spreadsheet controls the exact safe areas and zones. The diagram below shows the required hierarchy, not substitute pixel values.



Required hierarchy

Logo in the upper-left approved zone; title in the upper-middle; compact event details before or adjacent to the hero; hero as the dominant middle visual; CTA in the active lower-third zone above the bottom interface-safe area.

A 9:16 canvas alone is not enough. The composition fails if required content enters an unsafe area, the title exceeds two lines, the CTA falls too low, or the hero is reduced to a small decorative tile.

6. Contrast, CTA, and exclusions

Required copy must use a solid field or a sufficiently dark navy overlay when it crosses bright photography. Avoid placing cream text directly over high-detail highlights.

CTA treatment

The event CTA should read as a single, deliberate action. Use process orange as the primary CTA field with navy type, or an equivalent approved treatment with equal contrast. Do not turn the CTA into a small footnote or a decorative badge.

Do not introduce

- Tuition discounts, scholarship percentages, or sale language.
- Guaranteed employment, guaranteed portfolio results, or admissions promises.
- Application deadlines, QR codes, or URLs not supplied in the current brief.
- Legacy crest systems, graduation-cap motifs, unrelated academic-program imagery, or generic campus architecture as the sole hero.
- Multiple badges, competing calls to action, or extra decorative logos.

Final check

The finished image should look like one coherent Northstar event Story, not a collage of extracted rules. Do not display filenames, asset IDs, approval notes, dimensions, or the source checklist in the artwork.